"If there is one thing sure in this world besides death and taxes it is that Jewish circles will always harass Poland about restitution for property lost during the war and immediately after it," wrote Andrzej Dryszel in 2011.[22] This theme is echoed by others, including Stanisław Michalkiewicz, author of a scurrilous tract provocatively entitled *Herrenvolk po żydowsku* in which he accuses Jews of attempting to extort money from Poles. With the publication in 2014 of the book *Klucze i kasa*, the historians at the Polish Center for Holocaust who drew attention to the participation of Poles in the destruction of their Jewish neighbors cast further light on the tempting opportunities for self-enrichment during the German occupation.[23] This theme proved especially provocative not the least because of its implications about the large number of Poles who directly benefited, and whose descendants continue to benefit, from the wartime El Dorado brought about by the death sentence imposed on Polish Jewry.

It has often been said that the Jews are like the canary in the coal mine. If that analogy holds true, the air in present-day Poland is cleaner than it has been at any time in in recent history. Today the canary is singing, even if pollution still remains and there are occasional hiccups.

## POSTSCRIPT

In 2015, a year after this paper was presented and prepared for publication, elections were held in Poland. The right-wing, Euro-skeptic "Law and Justice Party" (PiS) was the resounding victor in both the presidential (May) and parliamentary (October) elections as Poles "voted for a better yesterday." Although the official policy of the party and its coalition partners cannot be characterized as antisemitic, in successive months the ambiance in the country has become increasingly *bogoojczyzniany* (a Polish term best translated as "God-fatherlandish")—in other words, nationalist, clerical, xenophobic, and authoritarian. Since that time, a number of manifestations of antisemitism have been reported. The most shocking were an extreme-right demonstration in Wrocław directed against the idea of accepting migrants in which a Hassidic Jew was burned in effigy on the city's old town market square (November), and a pro-government rally in Warsaw at which a banner with an unabashedly anti-Jewish slogan was unfurled (December). However, these events produced little reaction on the part of the authorities and certainly no unequivocal statement of opprobrium. No less disturbing were the utterances of several politicians, including a minister who is on record as having given credence to the validity of the *Protocols of the Learned Elders*

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